

CHAPTER

34



Galaganda

Learning Objectives

- ⇒ To learn the concept of Galaganda
- ⇒ To understand the Nidana Panchaka of Galaganda as mentioned in Ayurveda literatures
- ⇒ To learn the Asadhya Lakshana of Galaganda

Introduction

Galaganda is a spectrum of diseases where we can observe either a large or small swelling around the neck. If there are multiple swellings around the neck, such disease is termed as *Gandamala*. As there is a appearance of swelling it is considered to be due to the vitiation of *Kapha Dosha*.



Figure 145: Pratyatma Lakshana of Galaganda

As far as the current understanding is concerned, a single

swelling in the neck can be either thyroid swelling or lymph node swelling and multiple swellings observed around neck are probably due to infection such as tuberculosis or due to metastasis occurring secondary to malignancy.

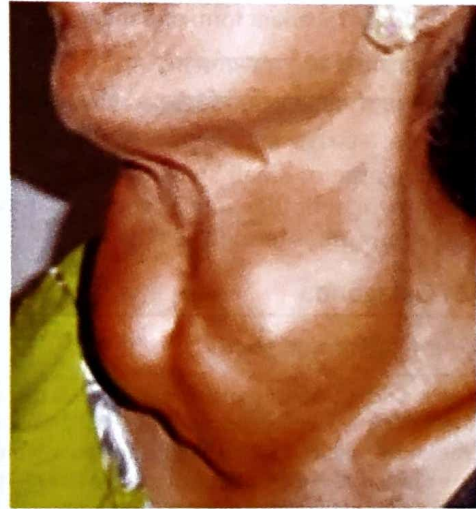


Figure 146: Lakshana of Gandamala

Definition

निबद्धः श्रयथुर्यस्य मुष्कवलम्बते गले।

महान वा यदि वा ह्रस्वो गलगण्डं तमादिशेत्॥1॥ Ma.Ni. – 38/1

*Galaganda*¹ is a either a huge or small swelling observed around the neck as if hanging around the neck like

1 पवनश्लेष्म मेदोभिर्गलगण्डो भवेद्वह्निः। वर्धमान. स कालेन मुष्कवल्लवतेऽतिरि॥5३॥

A.Hr.U. -21/53

The swelling produced due to the vitiation of Vata, Kapha and Medas which is externally seen and continuously growing. In due course of time, the swelling will look like scrotum and is painful.

appearance of *Mushka* (scrotum).

गलस्य पार्श्वे गलगण्ड एकः स्याद्गण्डमाला बहुभिस्तु गण्डैः।

Ca.Chi. – 12/79

Galaganda is a single swelling observed around the neck at the side of the throat. The disease where multiple swellings around the neck is termed as *Gandamala*.



Figure 147: Variant form of Gandamala

प्युक्तं, 'महान्तं शोथमल्यं वा हनुमन्यागलाश्रयम्।
लम्बन्तं मुष्कवद्दृष्ट्वा गलगण्डं विनिर्दिशेत् -' इति॥१॥

Madhu, Ma.Ni. – 38/1

Pendulum like large or small swelling observed around *Hanu* (temporo mandibular joint), and throat which is similar to the scrotum is termed as *Galaganda*.

Nidana of Galaganda

मात्स्यमाहिषवाराहपिशितामकमूलकम्।

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- 2 • Fish is a rich source of proteins upto 17-20%, fair source of vitamin B. Lysine, threonine are the proteins present in fish.
 - Meat of cattle, buffalo contains 17-20% of proteins, good source of vitamin B, iron, phosphorus, but a poor source of calcium.
 - The above said food substances are the poor source of iodine.
 - 3 All these substances are the poor sources of iodine. If a person continuously consumes these substances, there may be a possibility of iodine deficiency induced thyroid swelling.
 - 4 In this particular occasion, the person may develop halitosis (bad breath from the mouth secondary to poor dental hygiene). If a person develops swelling around the neck can be attributable to lymph node swelling.
 - 5 The above said measures are coming under the category of *Shodhana* (purificatory) procedures. The above said procedures are responsible for the inflammation of upper alimentary canal (mouth and surrounding structures, oesophagus or stomach). Improper post treatment measures may lead to the persistence of inflammation of upper alimentary canal including oral cavity and surrounding structures. For example, if *Dhumana* therapy is performed without proper post treatment measures, this may lead to persistence of inflammation of oral cavity, throat and surrounding structures. Thyroid gland one such organ which is situated in the throat region; thus inflammation of the thyroid gland may also be observed.
- As far as the functional anatomy of thyroid gland is concerned, the gland is composed of large numbers of closed follicles (100-300 micrometers in diameter) filled with a secretory substances called colloid and lined with cuboidal epithelial cells that secrete into the interior of follicles. In case of abnormal purificatory procedures performed, there will be inflammation of the gland leading to the hypertrophy of the thyroid cells leading to increased secretion of the thyroid gland. Thus, abnormal purificatory procedure used to eliminate the vitiated *Kapha* *Dosha* may lead to the abnormal functioning of the upper alimentary canal including thyroid gland.

माषसूपदधिक्षीरं सुक्तेक्षुरसफाणितम्॥१॥

अवाक्शय्यां च भजतो द्विषतो दन्तधावनम्।

धूमच्छर्दनगण्डूषानुचितं च सिराव्यधम्॥२॥

क्रुद्धा. श्लेष्मोत्वणा दोषाः कुर्वन्त्यन्तैर्मुखं गदान्। A.Hr.U. – 21/1-3

As per *Ayurveda* literatures, there is no specific aetiological factors (*Nidana*) causing *Galaganda* are being mentioned. *Galaganda* is specifically mentioned in *Ashtanga Hridaya* by *Vagbhata* in the context of *Mukharoga*. *Vagbhata* has mentioned specific *Nidana* (aetiological factors) for *Mukharoga*. Hence, these *Nidana* can be taken as *Nidana* for the manifestation of *Galaganda* too.

- Intake of fish, meat of buffalo, pig²
- Intake of unripe radish
- Soup prepared from blackgram
- Intake of curds, milk and milk products
- Intake of sugar cane and sugar cane products³
- Improper sleeping position
- Person who avoids brushing the teeth⁴
- Improper measures after *Dhumana* (medicated smoking), *Chardana* (emesis therapy), *Gandusha* (a specific measure of cleaning of oral cavity), *Siravyadha* (a form of blood letting)⁵

Samprapti of Galaganda

यस्य श्लेष्मा प्रकुपितो गलबाहोऽवतिष्ठते।

शनैः संजनयेच्छोफं गलगण्डोऽस्य जायते॥२॥

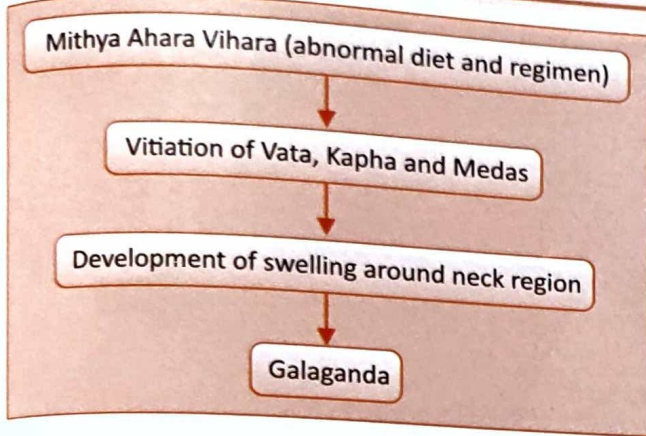
Ca.Su. – 18/21

वातः कफश्चापि गले प्रदुष्टो मन्ये च संश्रित्य तथैव मेदः।

कुर्वन्ति गण्डं क्रमशः स्वलिङ्गैः समन्वितं तं गलगण्डमाहुः॥२॥

Ma.Ni. – 38/2

First of all, there will be vitiation of *Kapha Dosha* in the body. when vitiated *Kapha Dosha* moves out from *Mahasrotas* afflicts *Medo Dhatu* and enters the external part of neck produces slowly progressing *Shopha* around the neck. This is termed as *Galaganda*.



Sankhya Samprapti

3 types:

1. Vataja Galaganda
2. Kaphaja Galaganda
3. Medoja Galaganda

Special Note: There is no mentioning of Pittaja Galaganda due to Vyadhi Svabhava (specific nature) of Galaganda.

Vataja Galaganda

तोदान्वितः कृष्णसिरावनद्धः श्यावोऽरुणो वा पवनात्मकस्तु।
पारुष्ययुक्तश्चिरवृद्धयपाको यदृच्छया पाकमियात्कदाचित्॥३॥
वैरस्यमास्यस्य च तस्य जन्तोर्भवेत्तथा तालुगलप्रशोषः।

Ma.Ni. – 38/3,4

कृष्णोऽरुणो वा तोदाढ्यः स वातात्कृष्णराजिमान्।
वृद्धस्तालुले शोषं कुर्याच्च विरसास्यताम्॥५४॥ A.Hr.U. – 21/54

Vataja Galaganda is associated with blackish or reddish coloured swelling, pricking type of pain, presence of black coloured veins over the swelling. This type of Galaganda is responsible for dryness of mouth and abnormal taste perception on increase in the size of the swelling.

Kaphaja Galaganda

स्थिरः सवर्णो गुरुप्रकण्डूः शीतो महाश्चापि कफात्मकस्तु॥४॥
चिराभिवृद्धिं भजते चिराद्वा प्रपच्यते मन्दरुजः कदाचित्।
माधुर्यमास्यस्य च तस्य जन्तोर्भवेत्तथा तालुगलप्रलेपः॥५॥

Ma.Ni. – 38/4,5

स्थिरः सवर्णः कृण्डूमान् शीतस्पर्शो गुरुः कफात्।

वृद्धस्तालुले लैप कुर्याच्च मधुरास्यताम्॥५५॥

A.Hr.U. – 21/55

Kaphaja Galaganda is associated with firm swelling around the neck. The colour of the swelling is similar to the colour of the body, itching. When there is increase in the swelling, the person is presented with sensation of coating over the palate and throat and sweetish taste of the mouth. The swelling is also associated with mild pain.

Medoja Galaganda

स्निग्धो गुरुः पाण्डुरनिष्ठगन्धो मेदोभवः कण्डुयुतोऽल्परुक् च।
प्रलम्बतेऽलाबुवदल्पमूलो देहानुरूपक्षयवृद्धियुक्तः॥६॥
स्निग्धास्यता तस्य भवेश्च जन्तोर्गलेऽनुशब्दं कुरुते च नित्यम्।

Ma.Ni. – 38/6,7

मेदसः श्लेष्मवद्भानिवृद्धयोः सोऽनुविधीयते।

देहं वृद्धश्च कुरुते गले शब्दं खैरेऽल्पताम्॥५६॥ A.Hr.U. – 21/56

Medoja Galaganda is associated with the features similar to clinical features of Kaphaja Galaganda. The swelling increases and decreases in its size in proportion to increase and decrease of size of the body. When there is increase in size of the swelling, the person may present with weak sound production.

Asadhya Lakshana of Galaganda

कृच्छ्राच्चसन्तं मृदुसर्वगात्रं संवत्सरातीतमरोचकार्तम्॥७॥
क्षीणं च वैद्यो गलगण्डयुक्तं भिन्नस्वरं चापि विवर्जयेत्।

Ma.Ni. – 38/7,8

Based on nature of swelling:

कर्कशुकोलामलकप्रमाणैः कक्षांसमन्यागलवङ्गणेषु॥८॥
मेदःकफाभ्यां चिरमन्दपाकैः स्याद्गण्डमाला बहुभिश्च गण्डैः।

Ma.Ni. – 38/8,9

- ⑥ When the person is presented with **breathing discomfort**⁶ (Shvasa)
- ⑥ Softness of the **body parts**⁷
- ⑥ When the duration of the illness is more than **one year**⁸
- ⑥ When the disease is associated with tastelessness (Arochaka), emaciation of the body (Kshina Deha) and hoarseness of voice (Bhinna Svava)
- ⑥ When the person is presented with Gandamala (group of swellings around the **neck**)⁹

6 When the swelling around the neck region compresses the upper respiratory passages may be presented with breathing discomfort. The nature of breathlessness in this occasion will be inspiratory in nature as partial or complete upper respiratory tract obstruction is observed in the suffering individual.

7 This is attributable to increased quantities of hyaluronic acid and chondroitin sulfate bound with protein form excessive tissue gel in the interstitial compartment. This will lead to the increase of interstitial compartment. As the fluid in the interstitial spaces is having gel nature, this is nonmotile and the oedema observed in non pitting type.

8 As per Ayurveda fundamentals, any of the disease which persists in an individual for upto one year or more, such diseases are considered to be incurable in nature.

9 Most common cause of this type of swelling is group of enlarged lymph nodes around the neck.

- ⊗ If the size of the swelling is like the size of *Karkandhu*, *Kola* and *Amalaka*¹⁰
- ⊗ If the swelling is seen in *Kaksha*, *Amsa*, *Manya*, *Gala* and *Vankshana*¹¹



Figure 148: Lymph node swelling in inguinal region

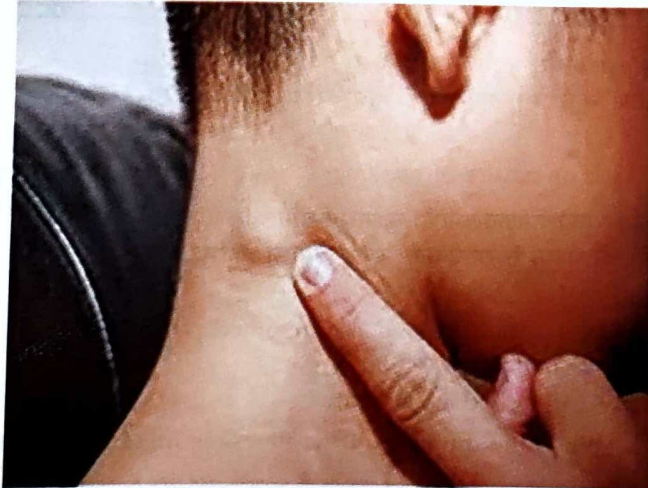


Figure 149: Lymph node swelling in the neck region

- ⊗ If the swelling is caused due to the vitiation of *Meda* and *Kapha*
- ⊗ If the swelling is slowly increasing in size¹²
- ⊗ If the swelling is slowly showing signs of suppuration¹³ (pus formation)

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- Karkandhu (*Ziziphus mauritiana*), also known as In, Indian jujube, Indian plum or Chinese apple (approximately 5 cms long)
Kola (*Ziziphus jujube*) – mid sized fruits (2-3 cms long)
Amalaka (*Embolica officinalis*) (approximately about 5 to 6 cms). The names of the fruits also indicate the consistency of the swelling. Kola, Karkandhu and Amalaka consistencies are smooth, little harder and little hardest respectively.
- The swellings observed in the axillary region, neck region and groin region is considered to be difficult in management. These swellings are considered to be lymph node swellings in these regions.
- There is a possibility of compression or infiltration of respiratory passages is considered to be difficult to cure.
- This is attributable to the mechanism of septic shock, spread of infection from the pus formed in the neck leading to high fever, marked vasodilation, high cardiac output, sludging of blood and disseminated intravascular coagulation sequentially.



Figure 150: Lymph node swelling in the axillary region

Self-Assessment: Questions for Reviews

Short essays

- ⊗ Explain *Galaganda* and *Gandamala*
- ⊗ Explain the *Nidana Panchaka* of *Galaganda* in brief

MCQs

- Which of the following is not the type of *Galaganda*?
a. Vataja; b. Pittaja;
c. Kaphaja; d. Medoja

Answer: (b)

- Galaganda* is a *Pradoshaja Vikara*.
a. Rakta; b. Medo;
c. Mamsa; d. Majja

Answer: (c)

- Sankhya Samprapti* of *Galaganda* is
a. 3; b. 5;
c. 7; d. 2

Answer: (a)

- Which of the following is not mentioned as the size of the swelling of *Galaganda* as per *Madhava Nidana*?
a. Karkandhu; b. Kola;
c. Amalaki; d. Vibhitaki

Answer: (d)

- Which of the following is considered under *Mamsa Pradoshaja Vikara*?
a. Gulma; b. *Galaganda*;

c. Grahani;

d. Hridroga

Answer: (b)

Chapter resources

- ✿ Madhava Nidana – 38th chapter: Galaganda Gandamala Apachi Granthi Arbuda Nidana
- ✿ Charaka Samhita Chikitsa Sthana – 12th chapter: Shvayathu Chikitsa Adhyaya
- ✿ Ashtanga Hridaya Uttara Tantra – 21st chapter: Mukharoga Nidana Adhyaya
- ✿ Sushruta Samita Nidana Sthana – 11th chapter: Granthi Apachi Arbuda Galaganda Nidana
- ✿ Golwalla's medicine for students by Aspi F Golwalla and Sharukh A Golwalla, edited by Milind Y Nadkar, 25th edition, Jaypee Brothers Medical Publishers (P) Ltd, New Delhi, 2017
- ✿ The Merck Manual of Diagnosis and Therapy by Robert S Porter and Justin L Kaplan, 19th edition, Merck Sharp & Dohme Corp, New Jersey, 2011

- ✿ Chamberlain's symptoms and signs in clinical medicine by Colin Ogilvie and Christopher C Evans, 12th edition, Butterworth-Heinemann Publishers, 1997
- ✿ Best & Taylor's physiological basis of medical practice by O P Tandon and Y Tripathi, 13th edition, Wolters Kluwer Health (India) Pvt. Ltd, Gurgaon, 2012
- ✿ Textbook of Medical physiology by Arthur C Guyton and John E Hall, 11th edition, Saunders Elsevier publications, Philadelphia, 2006
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